

Students should have an understanding of:

1.1	Revelation as proof of the existence of Allah; the Qur'an as revelation; revelation as shown in the Qur'an as direct (Surah 34:46–50) or through a messenger; divergent understandings of what revelation shows about the nature of Allah for Muslims.
1.2	Visions as proof of the existence of Allah: the nature and importance of visions in Islam; Qur'anic examples of visions, including Surah 19:16–22; reasons why they might lead to belief in the existence of Allah, and Muslim responses to non-religious arguments (including atheist and Humanist) which maintain that visions are hallucinations and provide no proof that Allah exists; divergent understandings of what visions show about the nature of Allah for Muslims, with reference to Sunni, Shi'a and Sufi Islam.
1.3	Miracles as proof of the existence of Allah: the nature and importance of miracles in Islam; the Qur'an as a miracle, including Surah 17:84–89; examples of miracles; reasons why they might lead to belief in the existence of Allah; Muslim responses to non-religious arguments (including atheist and Humanist) which maintain that miracles can be scientifically explained and provide no proof that Allah exists; divergent understandings of what miracles show about the nature of Allah for Muslims.
1.4	Muslim attitudes towards religious experiences and their use as philosophical arguments for the existence of Allah: the nature of a religious experience; Surah 2:118; divergent understandings of the nature and importance of religious experiences in Islam, with reference to Sunni, Shi'a and Sufi Islam; Muslim responses to non-religious (including atheist and Humanist) arguments that religious experiences do not provide proof that Allah exists.
1.5	Design argument: the design argument and its use in Islam as a philosophical argument for the existence of Allah and what it shows about the nature of Allah; divergent understandings of the nature and importance of the design argument for the existence of Allah in Islam, including reference to Surah 2:164; Muslim responses to non-religious (including atheist and Humanist) arguments against the design argument as evidence for the existence of Allah.
1.6	Cosmological argument: the cosmological argument and its use in Islam as a philosophical argument for the existence of Allah, including reference to kalam in the writings of al-Ghazali, including <i>Kitab al-Iqtisad fil'I'tiqad</i> ; what the cosmological argument shows about the nature of Allah; divergent understandings of the strengths and challenges of the cosmological argument in Islam; Muslim responses to non-religious (including atheist and Humanist) arguments against the cosmological argument as evidence for the existence of Allah.
1.7	Issues raised by existence of suffering and Allah as compassionate, including Surah 1: the problems the existence of suffering may raise for Muslims about the nature of Allah; how the problem and its basis as a philosophical argument may lead some people to reject belief in Allah or cause believers to question their belief.
1.8	The different practical and philosophical solutions offered to the problem of suffering and Allah as compassionate within Islam: Qur'anic, including Surah 2:151–177; theoretical and practical responses, including life as a test, prayer and charity; divergent understandings within Islam of their success in solving the problem.

21st Century

Students should have an understanding of:

2.1	The importance and purpose of marriage in Islam: the significance of marriage in Muslim life; Muslim teachings about marriage, including Surah 4; non-religious (including atheist and Humanist) attitudes to the importance of marriage in society, including a lack of importance, cohabitation and Muslim responses to these attitudes.
2.2	Muslim teaching about the importance of sexual relationships: divergent Muslim teaching about sexual relationships as fulfilling physical, emotional and spiritual needs; Muslim teachings on sexual relationships outside of marriage, including Surah 23:5–11 and same-sex sexual relationships; non-religious (including atheist and Humanist) attitudes to sexual relationships, including the acceptance of sexual relationships outside marriage and same-sex sexual relationships and Muslim responses to them.
2.3	Muslim teaching about the purpose and importance of the family: Muslim teaching about the purpose of families, including Surah 46:15–18: procreation and the strengthening of the ummah; divergent Muslim responses to the different types of family within 21st-century society (nuclear, single parent, same-sex parents, extended and blended families).
2.4	Support for the family in the ummah: how and why the community tries to support families, including through worship, rites of passage, classes for parents, groups for children and counselling; divergent understandings of the importance of this support for Muslims today and how it might strengthen the ummah, with reference to Surah 3:102–105.
2.5	Muslim teaching on contraception: divergent Muslim teachings and attitudes about contraception and family planning, including reference to Sahih al-Bukhari 34:432, and 62:136; different non-religious (including atheist and Humanist) attitudes to family planning and the application of ethical theories, such as situation ethics, and Muslim responses to them.
2.6	Muslim teaching about divorce: divergent Muslim beliefs, teachings and attitudes towards divorce and remarriage, including Surah 2:226–241 and the different rules for performing a divorce in Shi’a and Sunni Islam; different non-religious (including atheist and Humanist) attitudes to divorce and remarriage, including the application of ethical theories, such as situation ethics, and Muslim responses to them.
2.7	Muslim teaching about the equality of men and women in the family: divergent Muslim beliefs, teachings and attitudes about the role of men and women in the family with reference to the Qur’an, including Surah 4 and the time of Muhammad.
2.8	Muslim teachings about gender prejudice and discrimination: Muslim attitudes to gender prejudice and discrimination, including Surah 33:35; examples of gender equality in action in Islam.